Ross River virus

Many diseases are spread by contact between people but some are spread by **vectors**. Vectors are disease-carrying organisms. The mosquito is a common vector that can spread serious diseases such as malaria and dengue fever. In Australia the Ross River virus is spread by mosquitoes. The virus mostly infects people in rural areas, and causes a **flu-like** illness with a rash, joint pains and fever. Sometimes joints can become swollen. The illness can last for several weeks, making the patient feel weak and tired. Fortunately it is not fatal, but there is no specific treatment.

☞ **1** List the diseases that can be spread by mosquitoes. _____

_____

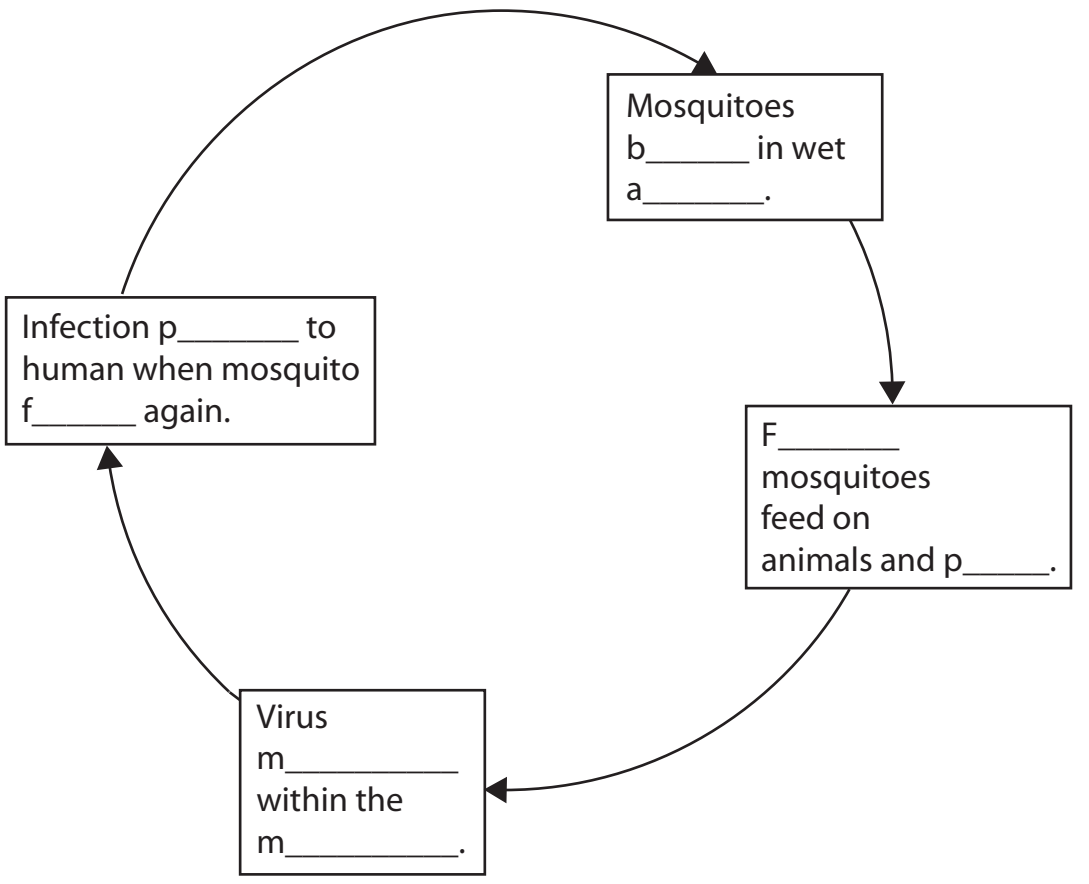
2 How can people protect themselves from being bitten by mosquitoes? _____

_____

3 Which of these is another word for fatal:

a) debilitating **b)** die **c)** death **d)** deadly

4 Complete the flow chart of the infection cycle.



Word bank

passes
Female
breed
areas
feeds
mosquito
multiplies
people

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